Nyaya-Vaisheshika recognises three types of causes. A piece of cloth is a whole product. Its underlying cause (*samavayi-karana*) is the threads (its parts) from which it is woven. The underlying cause is always a type of substance (***dravya***). The whole product exists in its parts by the relation of inherence (***samavaya***). In addition, the finished product is the underlying cause of its colour. Qualities (***guna***) need substances: they do not exist in their own right. So a substance is the underlying cause (indispensable condition) of the qualities inhering in it.

The companion cause (*asamavayi-karana*) is the combination of the threads by the relation of conjunction, which is a type of ***guna***. It needs to belong to a substance. That substance is the threads. Also, the colours of the threads are the companion cause in respect of the produced colour of the finished product. The companion cause is always a quality (or motion).

The efficient causes (*nimitta-karana*) are the weaver's activity and apparatus.

See ***Asatkaryavada***

Karana-vada: the Buddhists' belief in the essentially temporal nature of all entities involves a repudiation of the theory upheld by mainstream Brahminical orthodoxy that events and actions can be analysed in terms of specific real factors (***karaka***) such as a fixed starting point, the autonomous agent, objects and instruments. According to the Buddhists, there are just processes or sequences of events (*karana-vada*). Events follow other events but there are no real causal connections between them. It is a natural fact that some things happen in regular sequence but differentiation into agent, action, object, result and instrument is just a matter of human convenience reflected in the grammatical structures of language. It follows that individual people are just aspects of an event, enjoying no special significance.